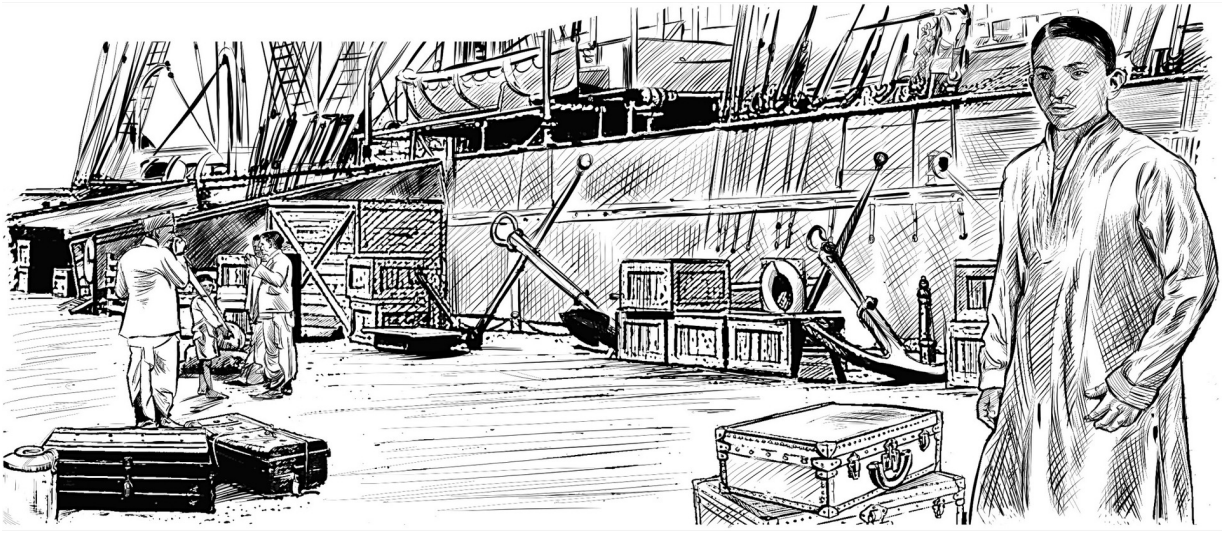
Chapter 2
London Lawyer

Mohandas Gandhi packed up and said good-bye to his family, including Kasturbai and their new baby son, Harilal. He headed to Bombay, India, where he would board a ship to London, England. Before he left Bombay, the leaders of the Modh Bania caste called him into a meeting. Traveling overseas was against the caste's rules. They thought he would be tempted to break the rules of Hinduism while in England.

If he went, then he would be kicked out of the Modh Bania caste and treated as an untouchable. Courageously, Gandhi still went. He was only eighteen years old when he set sail from Bombay on September 4, 1888.



Gandhi had a hard time fitting into a country so unlike his own. "Everything was strange-the people, their ways, and even their dwellings," he later wrote. He tried hard to become an "English gentleman." He spent a lot of money on a new suit, a top hat, silver-tipped cane, and leather gloves. He took lessons in manners, dance, French, and violin, like other Englishmen. But none of that helped his loneliness and homesickness.

Eating in London was hard for Gandhi, too. Before he left India, he had promised his mother that he would not eat meat. But finding vegetarian meals in London was difficult. Since Gandhi was shy, he didn't ask his